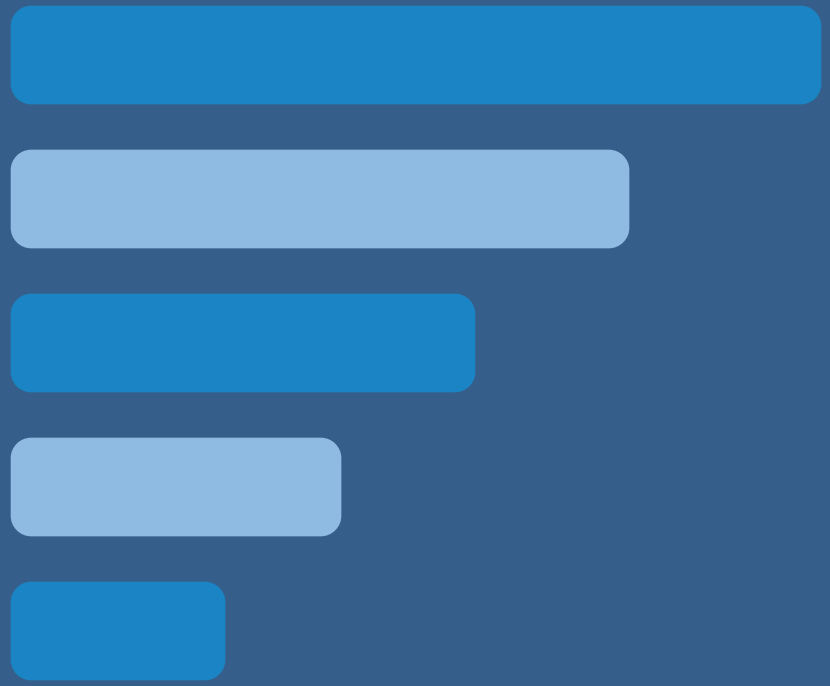
Latino Farmers in the U.S.: Survey Insights & Recommendations

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Helping ensure Latino farmers can access their rights, programs and information.

Executive summary: information and legal know-how, not only money, limit access

76%

rely on other farmers for agricultural information

Q28, n=123

53%

prefer to receive information face-to-face or by word of mouth

Q29, n=124

33%

name limited knowledge of laws and regulations as a legal concern

Q16, n=126

48%

of farmers who have not applied to federal programs say they are not familiar with them

Q13b, n=75

Bottom line: this is a small-scale, family-run, mostly experienced community whose top worries are costs, prices and regulation. Peer networks and in-person events are the most trusted path to reach them, so rights, program and legal information should travel through those channels, in plain language.

An experienced, mostly 46+ community; nearly half are immigrants

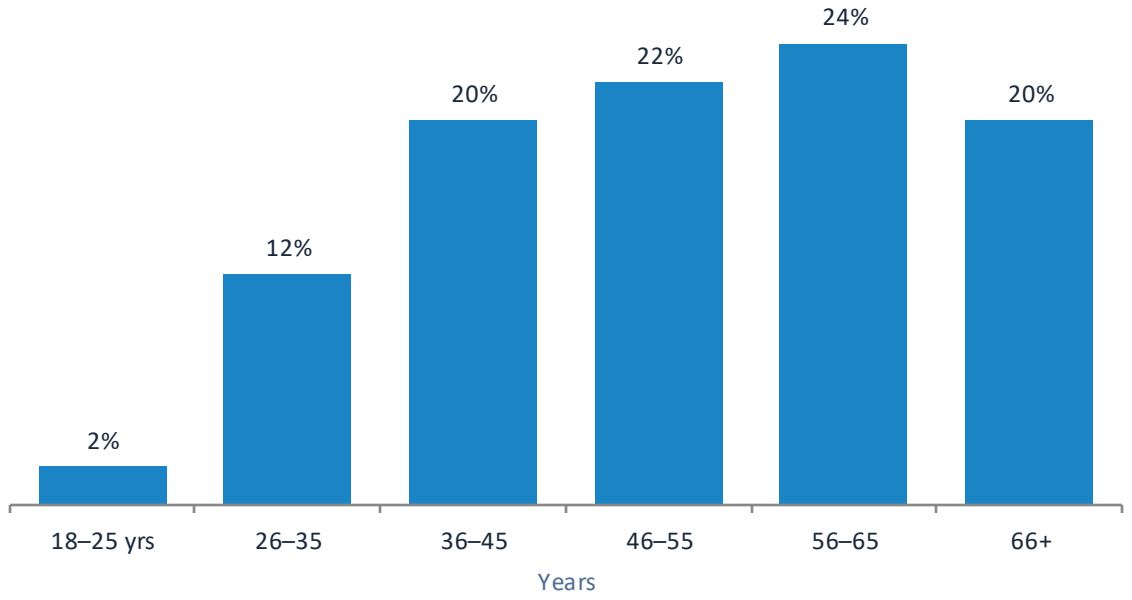
66% are 46 or older (83 of 126)

44% were born outside the U.S. (52 of 118); 54% of them have lived here 31+ years

15% report basic or no spoken English; written English: 15%

28% have high school or less (40% hold a 4-year degree or more)

Age of respondents (% of 126)



So what: written Spanish is weaker than spoken (31% vs 20% basic or none), so audio, video and in-person formats will reach more people than text-only materials in either language.

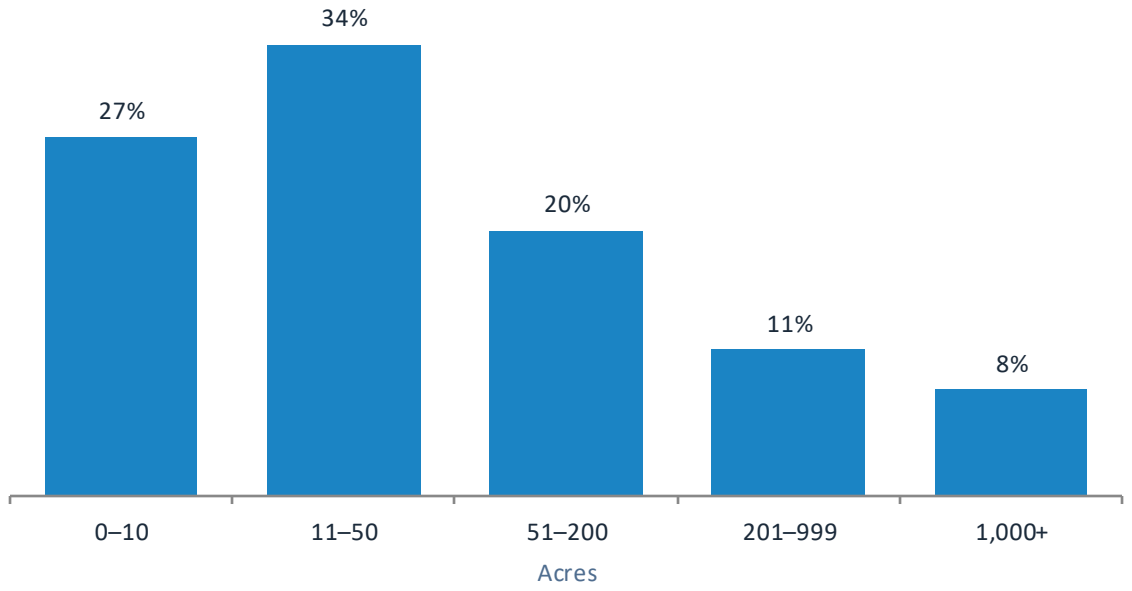
Small, family-run operations dominate the sample

61% farm 50 acres or fewer (74 of 122)

49% have 3 or fewer workers (62 of 126)

57% have farmed 11 to 30 years (71 of 124)

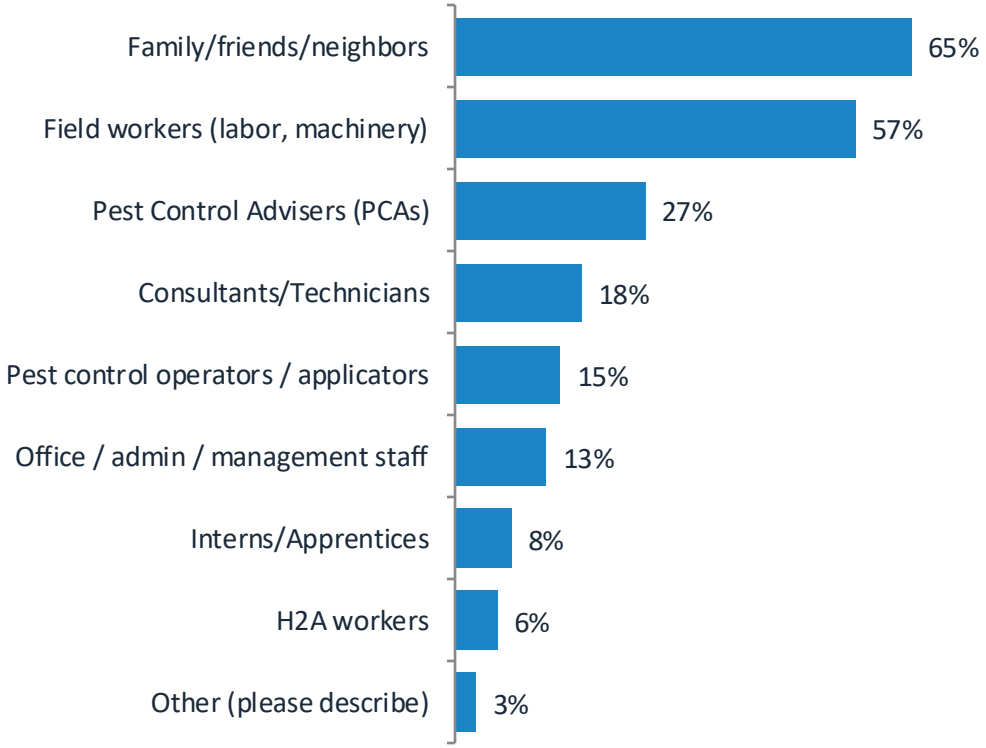
Farms by total acres (% of 122 farms)



So what: small farms rarely have HR, legal or grants staff, so rights and compliance guidance has to be simple, low-cost and easy to use in Spanish.

Family and hired field labor power most operations

Types of help/labor used (% of 124)



65%

use family, friends or neighbors

57%

use field workers (71 farms)

24%

employ 9 or more workers (30 farms)

6%

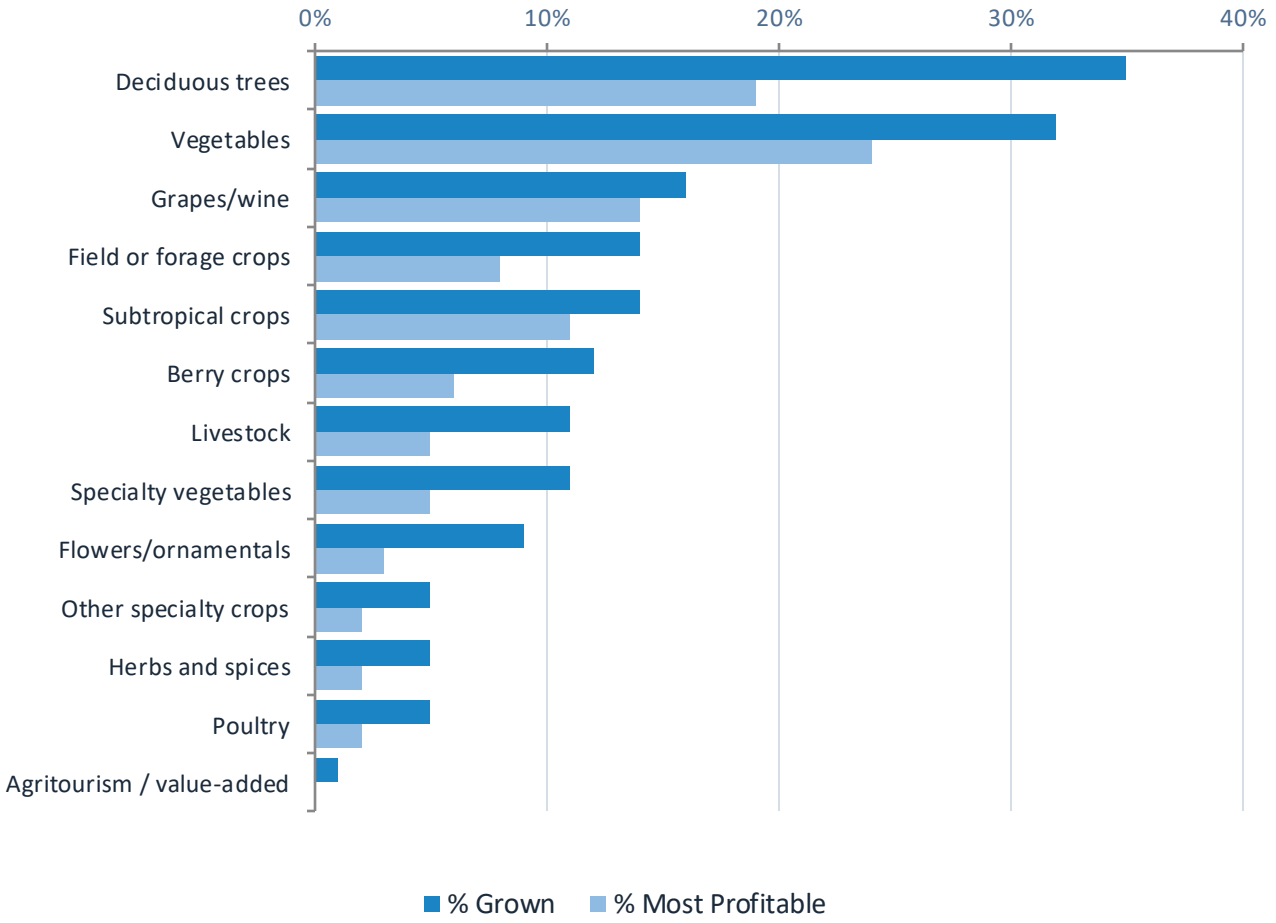
use H2A workers (7 farms)

34 farms (27%) use only family/friends with no field workers.

So what: 51% of farms have 4 or more workers, so labor-rights and compliance guidance matters to about half of respondents, while informal family labor needs separate guidance.

Tree crops and vegetables lead; grapes and subtropicals earn the most per grower

Share of respondents: grown (n=133) vs. most profitable (n=63)



Broad base. Deciduous trees (35%) and vegetables (32%) are the most common crops, and farms grow 1.7 crop categories on average.

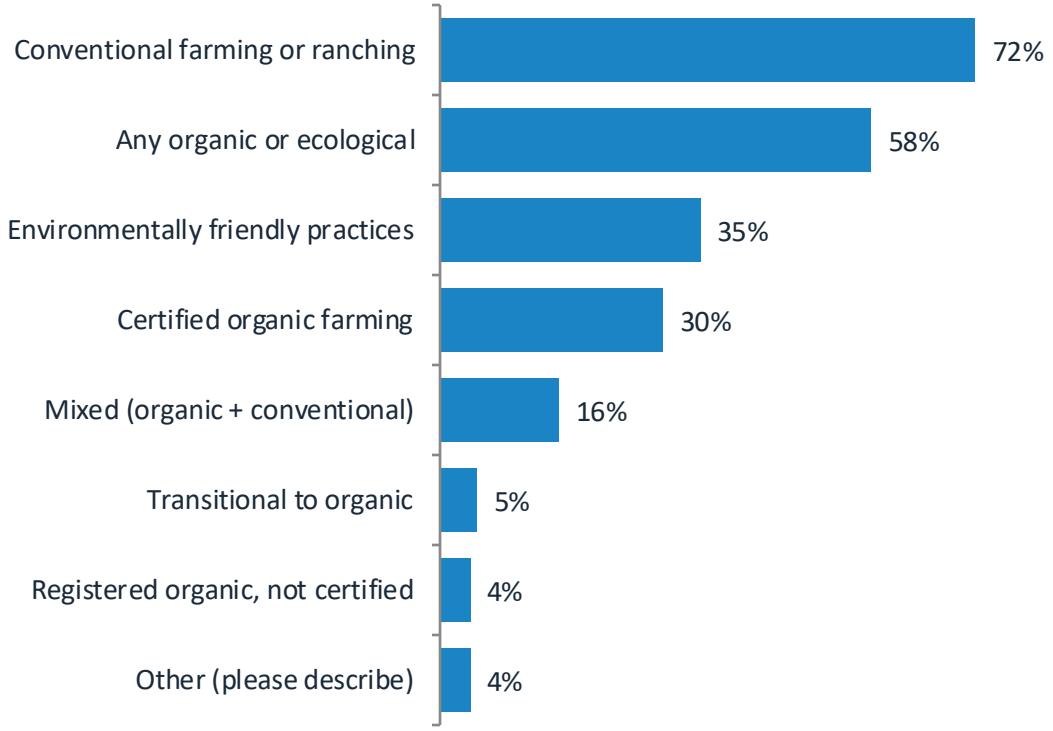
Vegetables top profit. 24% name vegetables as their most profitable crop, ahead of deciduous trees (19%) and grapes/wine (14%).

Higher return per grower. 43% of grape/wine growers (9 of 21) and 39% of subtropical growers (7 of 18) name it most profitable, vs. 26% of deciduous growers.

Q5 was answered by 63 respondents, so profit comparisons are directional.

Organic and ecological practices are widespread, but certification lags

Production systems (% of 124 farms, multi-select)



58% use any organic or ecological practice (72 of 124)

30% hold certified organic status (37 of 124)

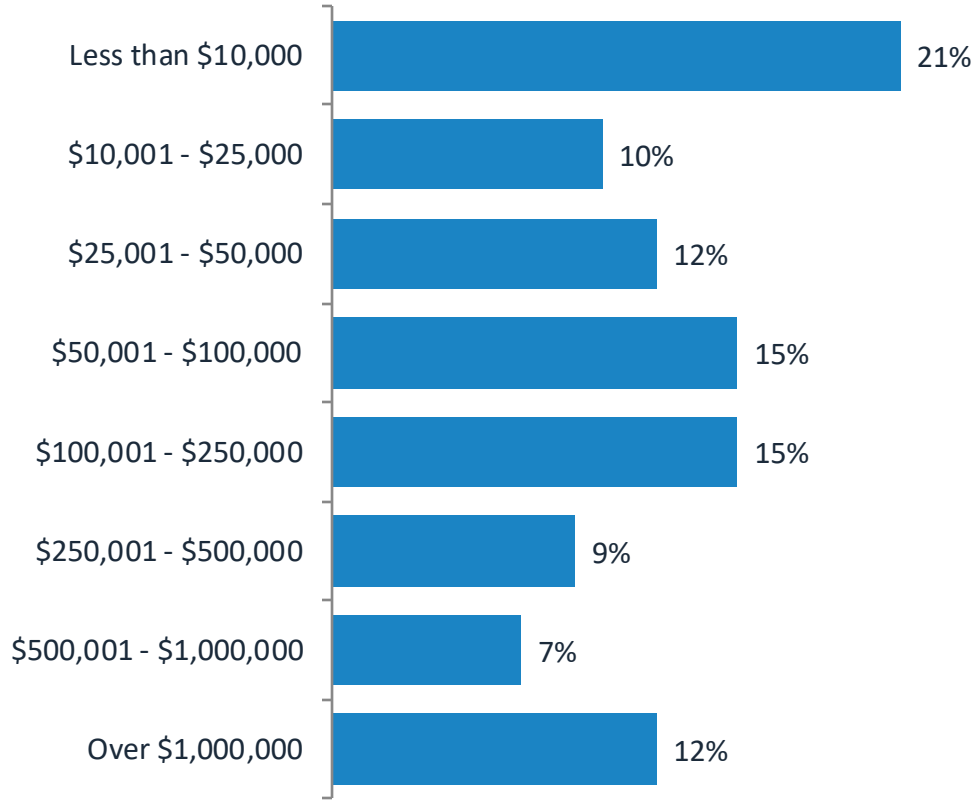
49% of organic/ecological farms are not certified (35 of 72)

Conventional farming remains the most common system at 72%; many farms combine approaches.

So what: certification cost and paperwork may be a barrier. Technical assistance and cost-share enrollment could close an access gap for small producers.

Most farms sell small volumes, mainly through wholesale and intermediate markets

Total annual sales (% of 117 farms)

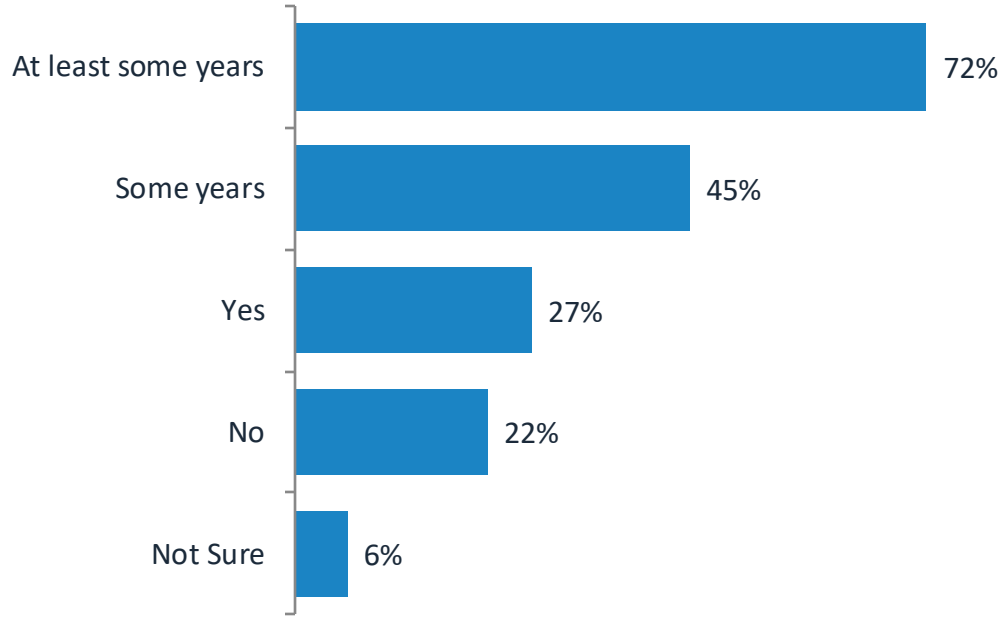


Small scale. 43% sell less than $50,000 a year and 58% less than $100,000, while 12% exceed $1 million.
Wholesale leads. 73% sell wholesale or to intermediate markets (124 respondents) and 40% sell direct to consumers.
Limited retail and online. Retail markets 24%, institutions 8%, e-commerce 6%.

So what: most farms sell under $100,000 a year, so program eligibility rules and paperwork written for larger operations can shut them out.

Most farms profit in some years, yet few count their own labor as a cost

Is your farm/ranch profitable? (% of 122)



27% answer an outright Yes on profitability; 72% are profitable in at least some years

67% do not include pay for their own time in production costs (74 of 110)

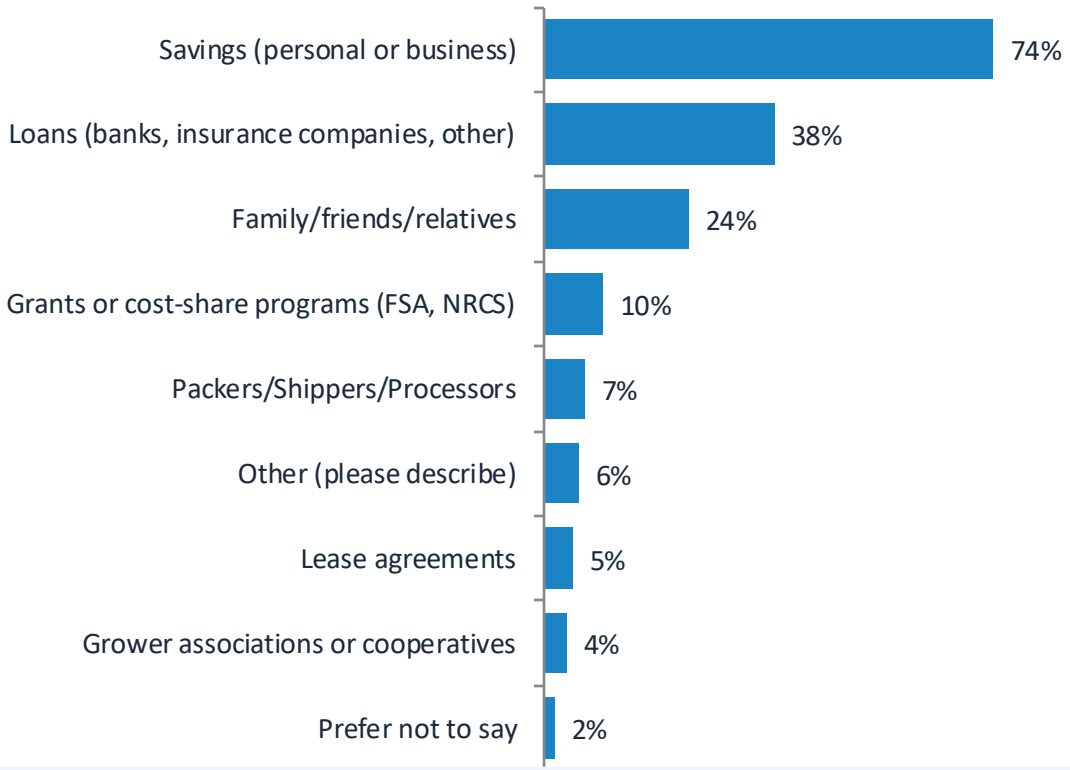
62% rely on off-farm income; for 38% of them it is over 75% of household income

22% say the farm is not profitable and 6% are not sure.

So what: reported profit is probably overstated because unpaid owner labor is not counted, and many households depend on outside jobs. Financial help should address household cash flow, not only the farm.

Farms are self-financed, and many rent land without a written lease

Primary sources of funding (% of 130)



74% fund the farm from savings

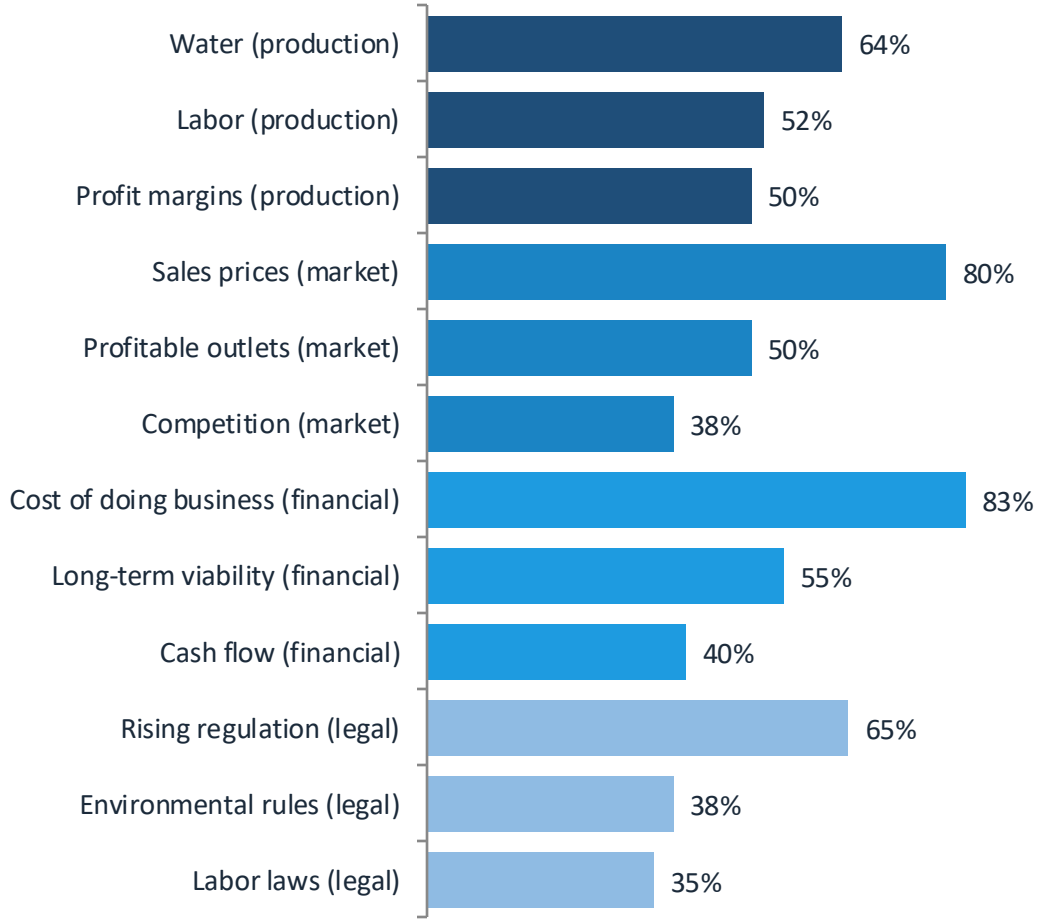
10% have used grants or cost-share programs

40% of 45 renters use cash rent with no lease agreement; another 9% are unsure of their lease type

So what: unwritten leases leave tenants exposed to sudden rent changes or loss of land, and low grant use suggests public funding is not reaching these farms.

Costs and prices top every list of concerns, with regulation close behind

Top 3 concerns in each area (% of respondents)



Money first. Cost of doing business is the most-cited financial concern (83%) and sales prices the top market concern (80%).

Water and labor. Water (64%) and labor (52%) lead production worries.

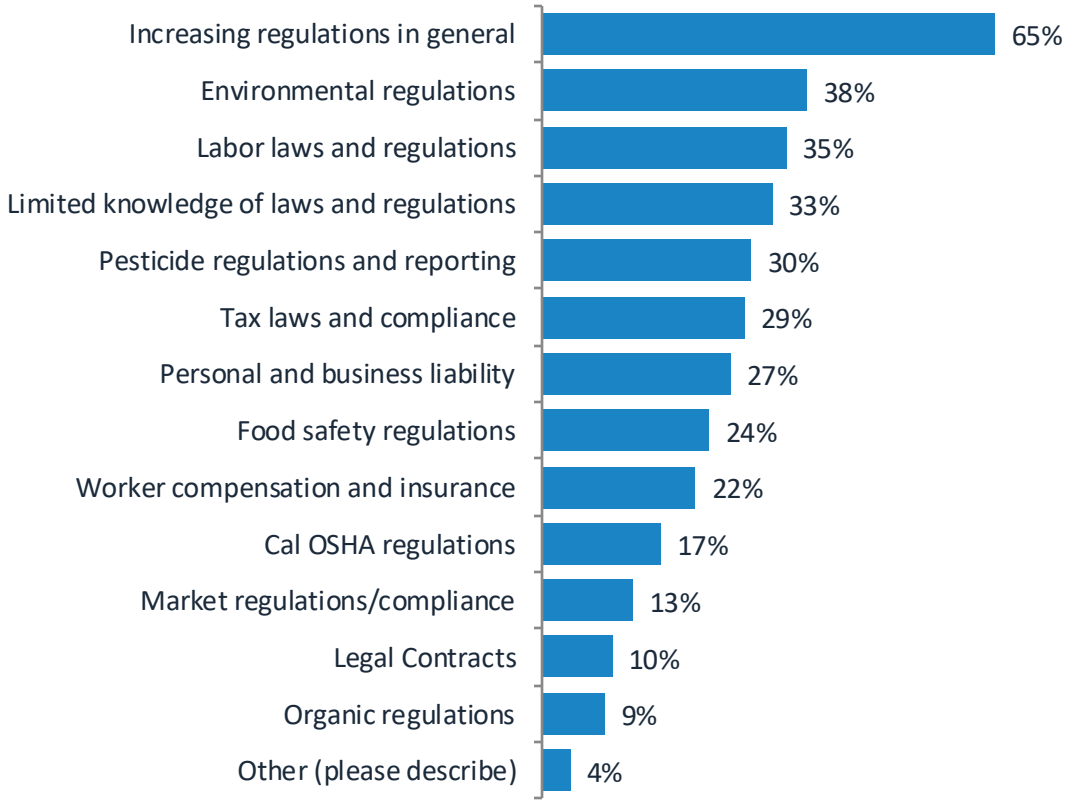
Regulation. 65% cite increasing regulation in general as a legal concern.

Fewer buyers. 50% say there are too few profitable market outlets.

Bar colors group the four areas: production (dark), market, financial, legal (light). n = 131 (Q6), 131 (Q8), 130 (Q10), 126 (Q16).

Legal concerns center on regulation, labor rules and not knowing the law

Top legal concerns (% of 126)

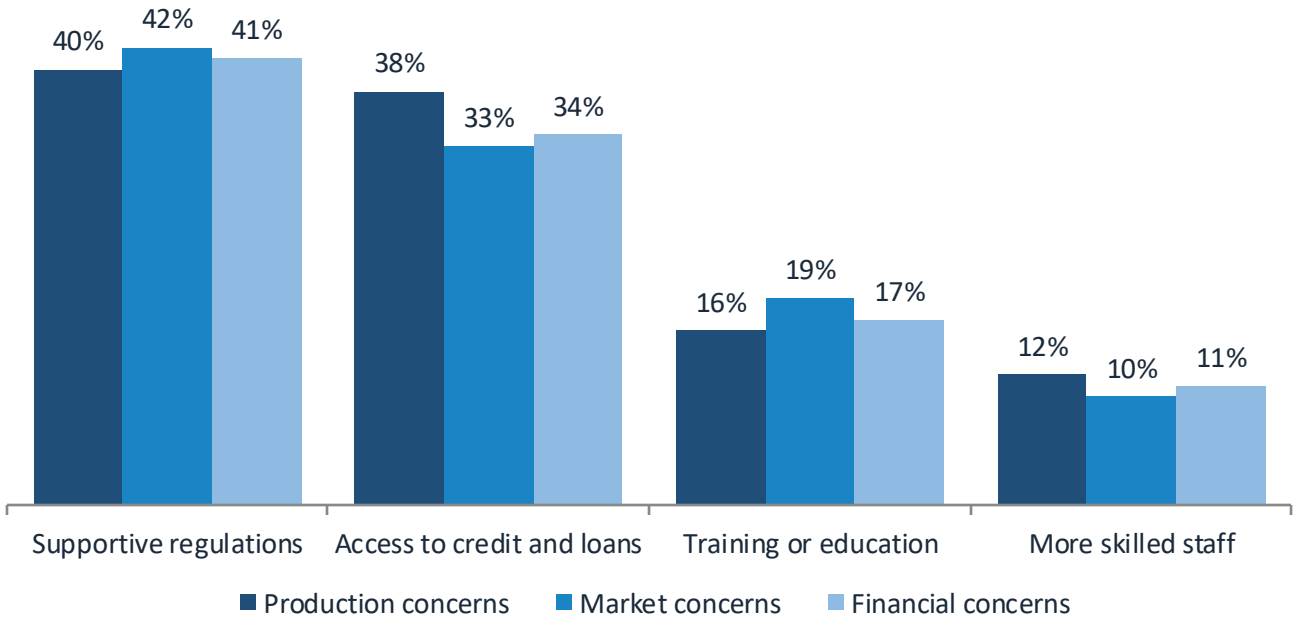


Rules keep growing. 65% cite regulation in general; environmental rules follow at 38%.
Knowledge gap. 33% name limited knowledge of laws and regulations (41 of 126).
Labor and safety. Labor laws 35%, worker compensation 22%, Cal OSHA 17%.
Open-ended answers. Write-ins include unawareness of which laws apply, liability waivers and racism.

So what: a third say they do not know the laws that apply to them. A plain-language know-your-rights guide with labor and safety basics fills an expressed need.

Supportive regulations and access to credit are rated most important to address every concern

% rating each need 'Most Important' for each type of concern



Regulation is the top ask. 'Most Important' for 40% (production), 42% (market) and 41% (financial); about 61% put it in their top two.

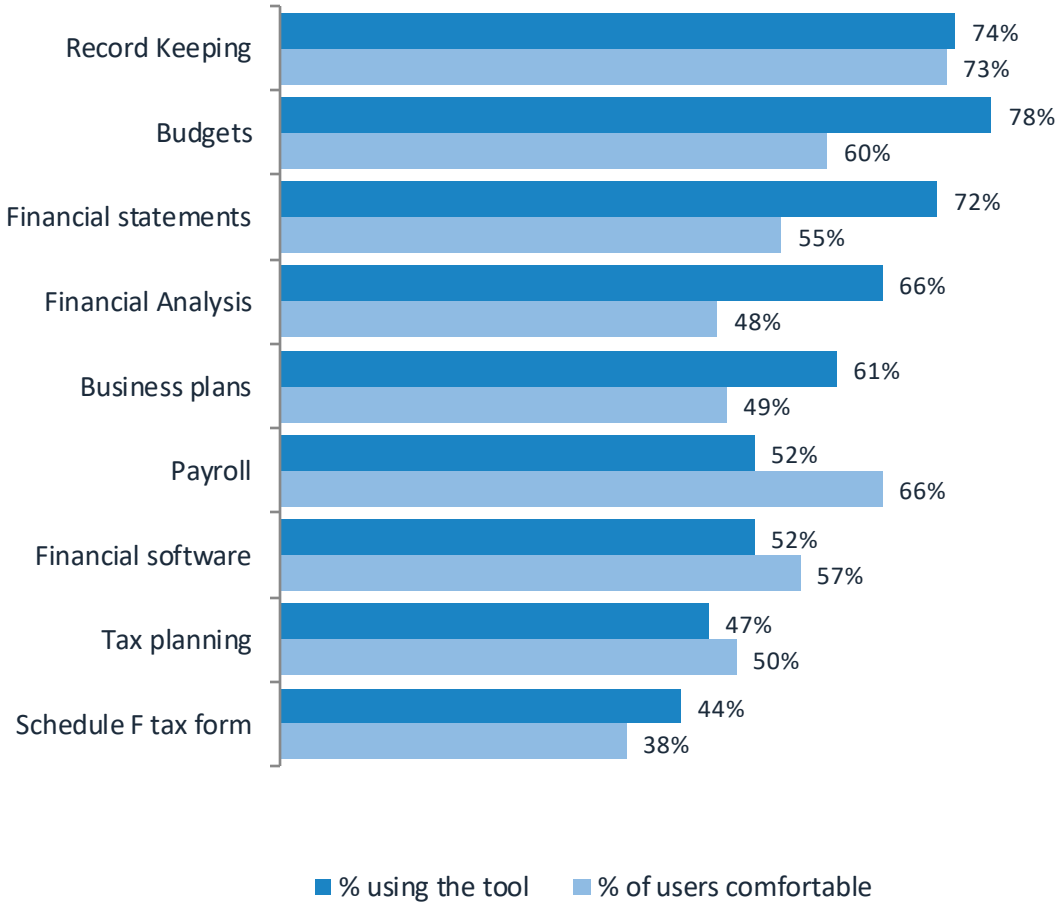
Credit comes next. Access to credit is most important for 38%, 33% and 34%.

Skilled staff rank last. Only 12%, 10% and 11% rank more skilled staff first.

So what: farmers ask for rules that work for them and for fair access to credit, which are rights and access issues rather than training gaps.

Core bookkeeping is common; tax work is outsourced and users feel less sure of it

% who use each tool and % of users who feel comfortable with it



Basics are widespread. Record keeping 74% and budgets 78% are used by most farms.

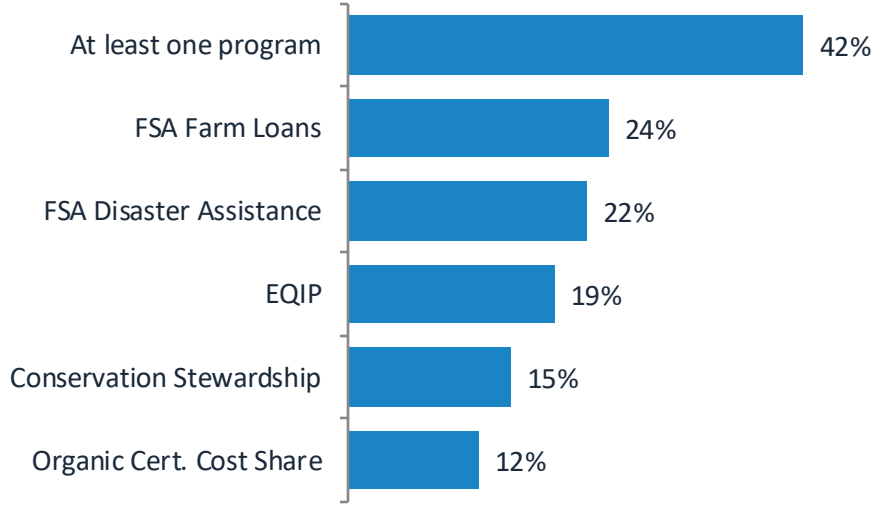
Tax work is delegated. Someone else handles tax planning for 33% and the Schedule F form for 37%.

Less comfort with advanced tools. Only 38% of Schedule F users are comfortable, vs. 73% for record keeping.

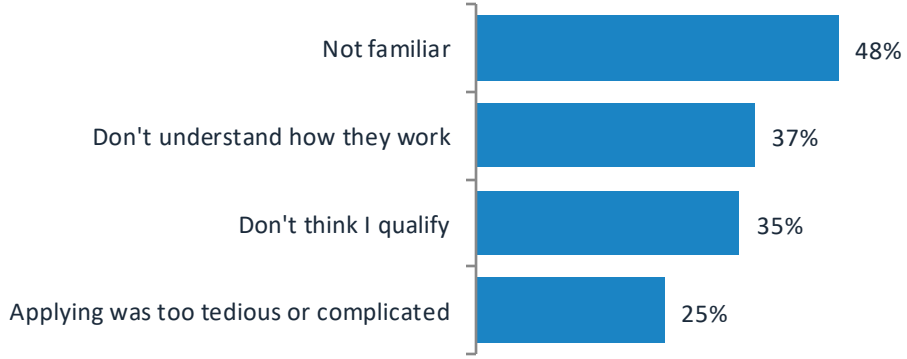
Demand for training. 62% say training would be beneficial (81 of 130).

Fewer than half have applied to federal programs; unfamiliarity is the main barrier

% who applied, by program (n = 121 to 129)



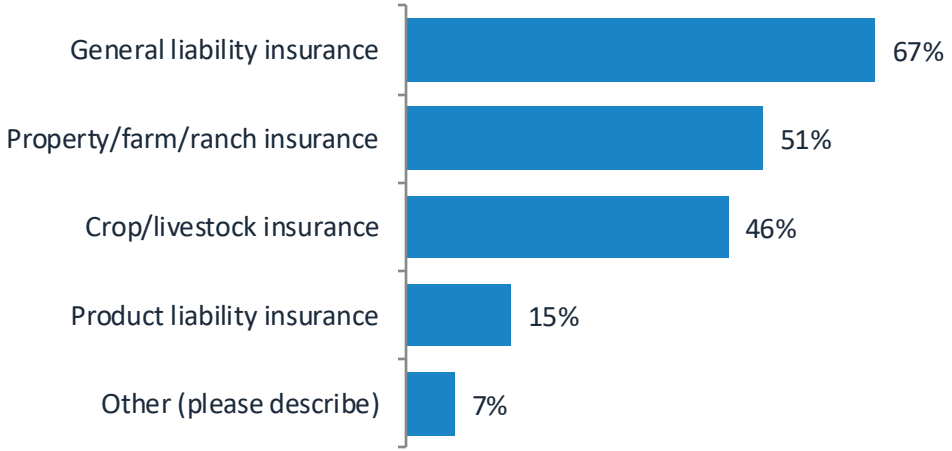
Why not? Top reasons (% of 75 non-applicants)



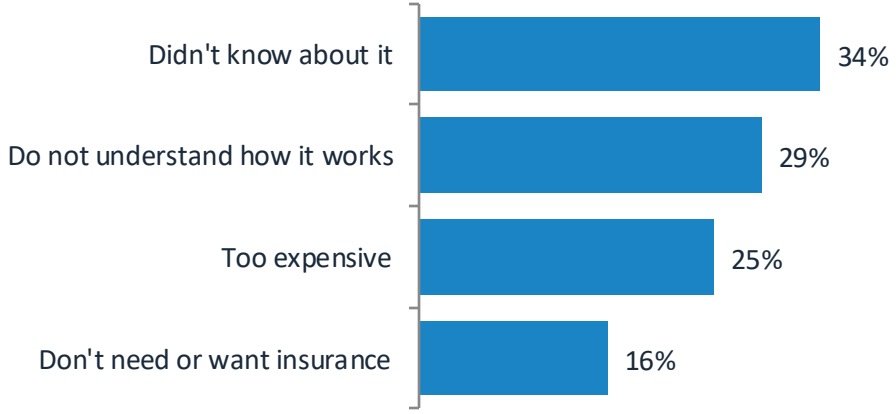
Reach is limited. 42% have applied to at least one program (54 of 129), while 33% have not even considered one.
Individual programs are used by a minority. Applicants range from 12% (organic cost share) to 24% (FSA farm loans).
Barriers are about information. 48% are not familiar, 37% do not understand how programs work and 35% assume they do not qualify.
Process and language. 25% found applying too complicated, 24% lacked help and 4% cite missing Spanish materials.

Liability and property cover are common; crop insurance is held back by awareness

Insurance used (% of 104)



Why no crop/livestock insurance? Top reasons (% of 56)



Common cover. General liability 67% and property 51%; crop/livestock insurance 46% (48 farms).

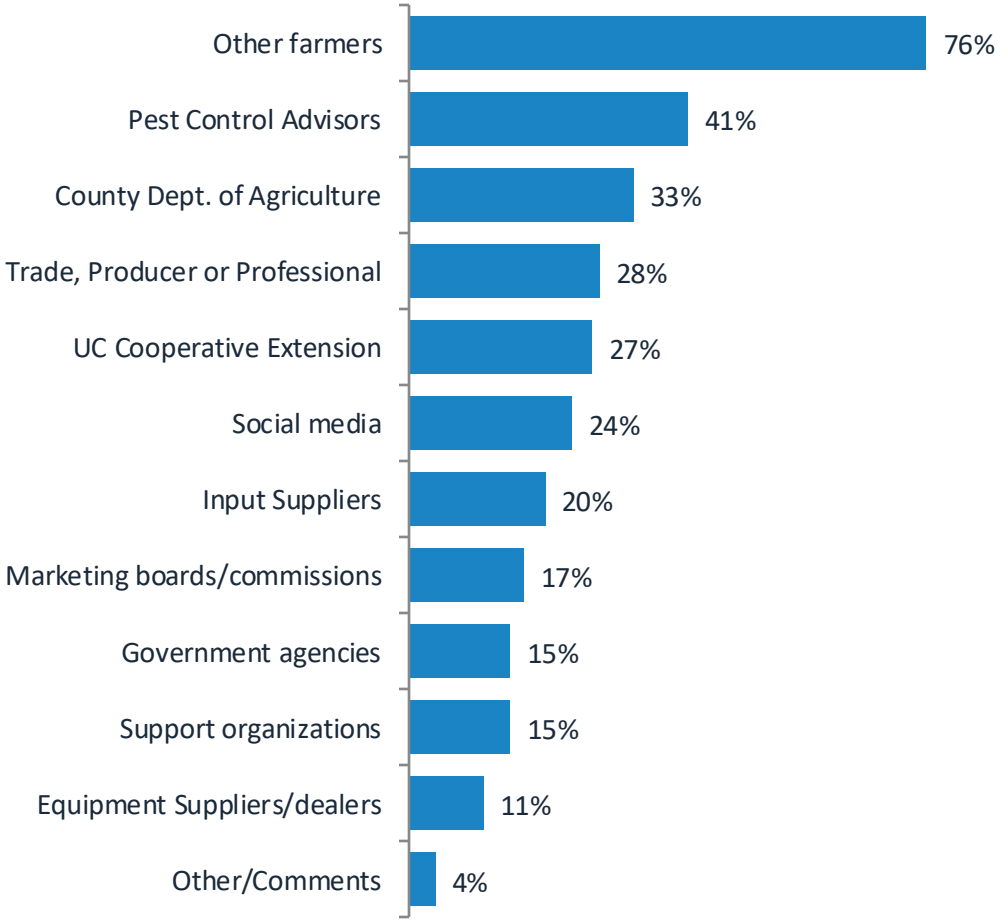
Most use commodity policies. 69% of crop-insurance users hold commodity policies, and only 6% use Whole Farm Revenue Protection.

Awareness, not only price. 34% of non-users did not know about it and 29% do not understand it; 25% say it is too expensive.

Buyers can require it. 10 of 16 product-liability holders (63%) say it is required.

Farmers learn from farmers; institutions reach about a third or less

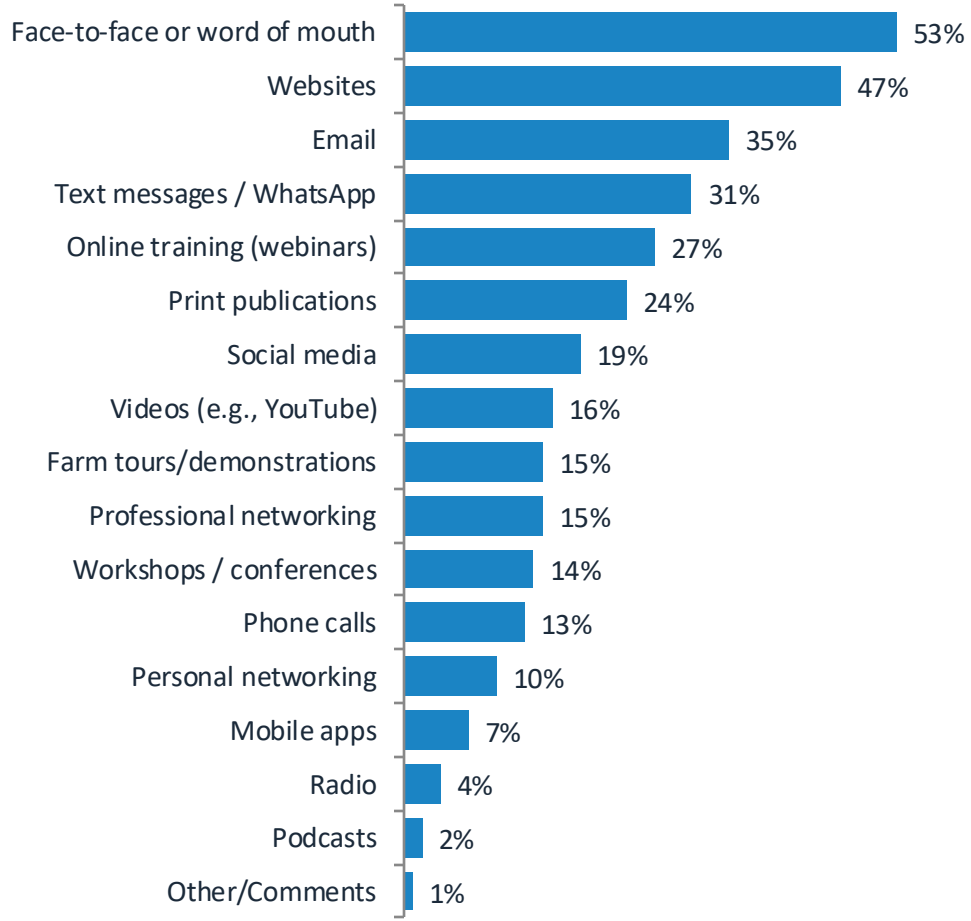
Main sources of agricultural information (% of 123)



Peers lead. 76% rely on other farmers (94 of 123), more than twice the reach of the County Dept. of Agriculture (33%).
Advisers are the strongest professional channel. Pest Control Advisors reach 41%.
Institutions are thin. UC Cooperative Extension reaches 27% and government agencies 15%.
Implication. Information about programs, labor rules and complaint channels probably spreads by word of mouth, so its accuracy depends on peers.

In-person contact leads, but websites, email and texting follow close behind

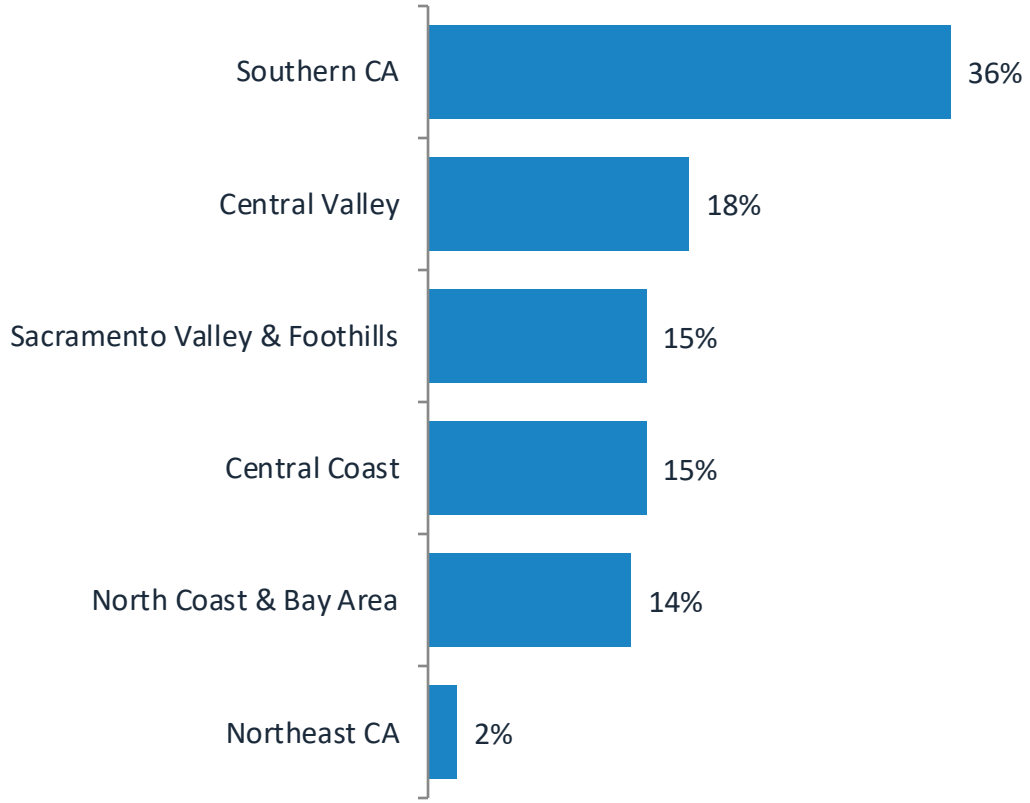
Preferred ways to receive information (% of 124)



Face-to-face first. 53% prefer face-to-face or word of mouth (66 of 124).
Digital is a strong second tier. Websites 47%, email 35% and text/WhatsApp 31%.
Hands-on formats add up. Farm tours/demonstrations (15%) and workshops/conferences (14%) complement one-to-one contact.
Low priority. Mobile apps (7%) and radio (4%) rarely appear.

Over a third of respondents are in Southern California

Respondents by region (% of 121)



Southern California leads. 36% of respondents (44 of 121), well ahead of the Central Valley (18%) and the Central Coast, Sacramento Valley and North Coast (14–15% each).
Top 5 counties. Riverside, San Diego, Monterey, Santa Cruz and Madera account for 40% of responses.
Thin rural coverage. 12 of 34 counties have a single respondent, and the Northeast has just 2%.

So, what: outreach should be anchored in high-density counties but needs regional events or mobile partners in the Central Valley and rural north.

How to read these results: four cautions

1 Self-selected sample

Respondents chose to take part and were likely reached through networks, so results describe this sample, not all Latino farmers.

2 Varying sample sizes

Questions have 16 to 133 responses; follow-up items such as Q5, Q14d and Q31b are small, so those comparisons are directional.

3 Associations, not causes

Peer reliance or low program use does not prove that information gaps cause worse outcomes. It shows where gaps may exist.

4 Discrimination items still to link

This dashboard covers concerns, finances, insurance and demographics. Direct discrimination items should be cross-tabbed by language, age, farm size and region before conclusions.

Six recommendations grounded in the survey

1 Build a peer-ambassador network

76% rely on other farmers. Train respected growers to share rights and program information.

2 Lead in person, back with messaging

53% prefer face-to-face; 31% text/WhatsApp. Pair field days with a group chat.

3 Add program and insurance navigators

48% of non-applicants are unfamiliar with federal programs and 34% never heard of crop insurance. Offer hands-on help in Spanish.

4 Publish a know-your-rights toolkit

33% lack legal knowledge; labor laws worry 35%. Cover labor, safety and complaint channels.

5 Secure land tenure and credit

40% rent without a lease and credit is a top ask (38% most important). Offer lease templates and credit guidance.

6 Reach under-served groups and places

12 of 34 counties have one respondent; 15% have basic spoken English and 66% are 46+. Use regional, bilingual events.

Next steps: a phased plan with measurable targets

0–3 months: Foundation

- Recruit and train peer ambassadors in the top 5 counties
- Translate rights, program and insurance guides into plain-language Spanish and English
- Set up a text/WhatsApp broadcast line

3–9 months: Pilot

- Run field days with PCAs and County Ag Dept. staff
- Pilot navigators for FSA, EQIP and crop-insurance enrollment
- Launch the know-your-rights and lease toolkit

9–18 months: Scale and measure

- Add regional events in the Central Valley and rural north
- Cross-tab discrimination items by language, age, farm size and region
- Repeat the survey and compare against targets

Proposed targets for the next survey wave

42% → 55%

applied to at least one federal program

40% → 25%

of renters with no written lease

33% → 20%

cite limited knowledge of laws and regulations